

Cybersecurity Daily Newsletter

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Top 5 Highlights

- Agentic AI identity: A 6-stage maturity model for non-human identities
- 'GodDamn' Ransomware Uses BYOVD to Smite US Companies
- Police arrests 5,800 suspects in global anti-fraud crackdown
- Why fixing your data architecture matters more than upgrading your detection models
- Microsoft Patches RoguePlanet Defender Flaw That Can Grant SYSTEM Privileges

Threat Intelligence (10)

01. AWS centralizes access, spending, and governance for Claude

Claude apps gateway for AWS is a self-hosted control plane that gives organizations a single point of control over access, costs, and policies for Claude Code and Claude Desktop. It replaces per-developer cloud credentials, manual distribution of managed settings to developer laptops, and centralizes usage attribution and spending controls. The gateway can...

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Update detections and threat hunts using reported TTPs/IOCs, review email/web controls, and harden high-risk internet-facing services.

Sources: <https://www.helpnetsecurity.com/2026/07/09/aws-claude-apps-gateway-governance/>

02. Fake 7-Zip Installers Turn Devices Into Residential Proxy Nodes

Cybersecurity researchers have disclosed details of a new threat actor dubbed Lurking Lizard that has been operating an end-to-end malicious residential proxy business using an infrastructure comprising more than 230 lookalike domains. The activity dates back to at least August 2022, according to DNS threat intelligence firm Infoblox. Once such campaign, ob...

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Sources: <https://thehackernews.com/2026/07/fake-7-zip-installers-turn-devices-into.html>

03. A single malware file can outweigh an entire AI dataset

Antivirus vendors and security startups keep shipping AI features that promise to read malware the way a seasoned analyst would. The results inside security teams tell a quieter story. A new paper argues that static analysis of software, the job of deciding whether a program is malicious by examining its contents on disk, remains one of the hardest places t...

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Sources: <https://www.helpnetsecurity.com/2026/07/09/research-ai-in-cybersecurity/>

04. ISC Stormcast For Thursday, July 9th, 2026

<https://isc.sans.edu/podcastdetail/10000>, (Thu, Jul 9th)

ISC Stormcast For Thursday, July 9th, 2026 <https://isc.sans.edu/podcastdetail/10000>, (Thu, Jul 9th)

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Update detections and threat hunts using reported TTPs/IOCs, review email/web controls, and harden high-risk internet-facing services.

Sources: <https://isc.sans.edu/diary/rss/33140>

05. GitHub's public APIs are becoming an enterprise reconnaissance tool

GitHub continues to be a scintillating target for attackers because it sits in the middle of the software supply chain and gives threat actors three things they crave: source code, secrets, and automated pipelines to run amok in. Datadog Security Research has been tracking what it calls a "sustained pattern" of GitHub API abuse over the past several months...

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Audit build pipelines, rotate CI/CD secrets, enforce package integrity controls, and review developer workstation hardening.

Sources: <https://www.csoonline.com/article/4194665/githubs-public-apis-are-becoming-an-enterprise-reconnaissance-tool-2.html>

06. Fake Paysafe, Skrill SDKs on NPM and PyPi steal credentials

Malicious packages on the Node Package Manager (npm) and the Python Package Index (PyPI) delivered stealer malware to developers and users of Paysafe, Skrill, and Neteller payment applications. [...]

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Update detections and threat hunts using reported TTPs/IOCs, review email/web controls, and harden high-risk internet-facing services.

Sources: <https://www.bleepingcomputer.com/news/security/fake-paysafe-skrill-sdks-on-npm-and-pypi-steal-credentials/>

07. Hackers exploit Roundcube flaw to spy on academic researchers

A China-linked threat cluster has been exploiting vulnerable Roundcube servers at U.S. and Canadian universities to steal credentials and deploy backdoor malware. [...]

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Update detections and threat hunts using reported TTPs/IOCs, review email/web controls, and harden high-risk internet-facing services.

Sources: <https://www.bleepingcomputer.com/news/security/hackers-exploit-roundcube-flaw-to-spy-on-academic-researchers/>

08. Vidar Infostealer Hammers SMBs via Malvertising Campaign

A financially motivated operation uses lures of cracked or pirated software to deliver a malware two-for-one combo for data theft and cryptomining.

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Recommendation: Update detections and threat hunts using reported TTPs/IOCs, review email/web controls, and harden high-risk internet-facing services.

Sources:

<https://www.darkreading.com/cyberattacks-data-breaches/vidar-infostealer-smb-malvertising-campaign>

09. HPC AI Workloads Need Runtime Security. The Architecture Already Exists.

Learn how to secure HPC AI infrastructure against runtime and supply chain threats via continuous behavioral monitoring.

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Audit build pipelines, rotate CI/CD secrets, enforce package integrity controls, and review developer workstation hardening.

Sources: <https://www.sentinelone.com/blog/hpc-ai-workloads-need-runtime-security-the-architecture-already-exists/>

10. China-Linked APT Expands Arsenal With New 'Leash' Backdoors

Cisco says the threat actor behind the LapDogs campaign has expanded its SOHO router malware toolkit with LongLeash, DogLeash, and JarLeash backdoors. The post China-Linked APT Expands Arsenal With New 'Leash' Backdoors appeared first on SecurityWeek .

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Update detections and threat hunts using reported TTPs/IOCs, review email/web controls, and harden high-risk internet-facing services.

Sources: <https://www.securityweek.com/china-linked-apt-expands-arsenal-with-new-leash-backdoors/>

Latest Vulnerabilities (10)

01. Agentic AI identity: A 6-stage maturity model for non-human identities

In a client engagement last year, an LLM-based deployment agent with standing access to a production Kubernetes cluster triggered a four-hour outage through a malformed configuration push. In the IAM, the agent appeared as a service account with a long-lived API key, no MFA, no scoped revocation path. When the incident review team asked which human had auth...

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://www.csoonline.com/article/4194548/agentic-ai-identity-a-6-stage-maturity-model-for-non-human-identities.html>

02. Why fixing your data architecture matters more than upgrading your detection models

Security leaders have been on a spending sprint. The global AI in cybersecurity market is valued at \$44 billion in 2026 and is projected to reach \$213 billion by 2034 , a trajectory that reflects genuine belief that machine learning will close the gap between the volume of threats and the capacity of human analysts. That belief is not wrong. What is wrong i...

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Sources: <https://www.csoononline.com/article/4194544/why-fixing-your-data-architecture-matters-more-than-upgrading-your-detection-models.html>

03. Microsoft Patches RoguePlanet Defender Flaw That Can Grant SYSTEM Privileges

Microsoft has released security updates for a Defender vulnerability known as RoguePlanet, nearly a month after details of the flaw became public. The vulnerability, tracked as CVE-2026-50656 (CVSS score: 7.8), is a privilege escalation issue in the Microsoft Malware Protection Engine ("mpengine.dll"), which provides scanning, detection, and cleaning capabi...

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Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://thehackernews.com/2026/07/microsoft-patches-rogueplanet-defender.html>

04. Cybercriminals Plant Malicious AI Agents in Open Source Tool Repositories

Cybersecurity researchers at ESET identify big rise in suspicious and malicious toolsets which put users at risk from cyber-attacks

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://www.infosecurity-magazine.com/news/cybercriminals-plant-ai-agents/>

05. Chrome 150 Update Patches 27 Vulnerabilities

The security refresh resolves 13 use-after-free bugs, including two critical-severity flaws found by Google. The post Chrome 150 Update Patches 27 Vulnerabilities appeared first on SecurityWeek .

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://www.securityweek.com/chrome-150-update-patches-27-vulnerabilities/>

06. Lateral movement risk rises as enterprises emphasize convenience over containment

Poorly segmented networks and weak security controls continue to undercut security organizations' ability to identify and contain attacks, giving attackers free rein after initial compromise, according to a recent study based on real-world enterprise security telemetry. Zero Networks' 2026 Lateral Movement Exposure Report - based on analysis of 54 trillion...

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Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://www.csoonline.com/article/4194708/lateral-movement-risk-rises-as-enterprises-emphasize-convenience-over-containment.html>

07. Microsoft patches RoguePlanet Defender zero-day vulnerability

Microsoft has released a security patch to address a Defender zero-day vulnerability known as "RoguePlanet," disclosed after the June 2026 Patch Tuesday. [...]

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://www.bleepingcomputer.com/news/microsoft/microsoft-patches-rogueplanet-defender-zero-day-vulnerability/>

08. [REVIVE-SA-2026-003] Revive Adserver Vulnerabilities

Posted by Matteo Beccati on Jul 08 =====
===== Revive Adserver
Security Advisory REVIVE-SA-2026-003

<https://www.revive-adserver.com/security/revive-sa-2026-003>
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Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://seclists.org/fulldisclosure/2026/Jul/19>

09. Top AI Agents Built to Catch Malicious Code Can Be Tricked Into Running It

Ask an AI coding agent to scan open-source code for security holes, and it might run the attacker's code on your own machine instead. That is the finding in a proof-of-concept published Wednesday by the AI Now Institute, an attack it calls "Friendly Fire." It works against Anthropic's Claude Code and OpenAI's Codex when either is running in an autonomous mo...

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Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://thehackernews.com/2026/07/friendly-fire-ai-agents-built-to-catch.html>

10. Open-source collaboration is growing worldwide and putting pressure on maintainers

Developers are pushing code and opening pull requests across economy borders at a rate GitHub has rarely seen. Outbound collaboration, the sum of git pushes and pull requests sent from developers in one economy to public repositories in another, grew by 16% from Q4 2025 to Q1 2026, according to the latest GitHub Innovation Graph data. That is the second hig...

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Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://www.helpnetsecurity.com/2026/07/09/github-open-source-collaboration/>

Data Breach & Cybercrime (10)

01. 'GodDamn' Ransomware Uses BYOVD to Smite US Companies

Microsoft co-signed a malicious kernel driver, and now it's being used to kill security software in ransomware attacks.

Why it matters: Ransomware operations combine disruption with extortion, making recovery speed and data-resilience core business risks.

Recommendation: Verify offline backups, test restores, harden remote access, and review segmentation to limit lateral movement.

Sources: <https://www.darkreading.com/cyberattacks-data-breaches/goddamn-ransomware-byovd-smite-companies>

02. Police arrests 5,800 suspects in global anti-fraud crackdown

Law enforcement agencies have arrested 5,811 suspects and seized \$293 million in illicit assets in a global anti-fraud operation spanning 97 countries. [...]

Why it matters: Breaches and cybercrime activity signal where attackers are focusing and what data types are actively monetized.

Recommendation: Validate incident-response readiness, monitor for exposed credentials, and reinforce MFA, phishing resistance, and data-loss controls.

Sources: <https://www.bleepingcomputer.com/news/security/police-arrests-5-800-suspects-in-global-anti-fraud-crackdown/>

03. AssuranceAmerica data breach exposes records of 6.9 million drivers

American insurance company AssuranceAmerica has disclosed a data breach impacting nearly 7 million drivers after attackers gained access to its systems earlier this year. [...]

Why it matters: Breaches and cybercrime activity signal where attackers are focusing and what data types are actively monetized.

Recommendation: Validate incident-response readiness, monitor for exposed credentials, and reinforce MFA, phishing resistance, and data-loss controls.

Sources: <https://www.bleepingcomputer.com/news/security/assuranceamerica-data-breach-exposes-records-of-69-million-drivers/>

04. The fake report message that ends with a stolen Reddit account

A direct message arrives on Reddit from a stranger, and it invites a reply. That reply is the point. This scheme runs on social engineering, with no malware and no malicious links, and it has spread across Reddit, Discord, and similar platforms. The goal is a single piece of information: a login or verification code that hands your account to someone else....

Why it matters: Breaches and cybercrime activity signal where attackers are focusing and what data types are actively monetized.

Recommendation: Validate incident-response readiness, monitor for exposed credentials, and reinforce MFA, phishing resistance, and data-loss controls.

Sources: <https://www.helpnetsecurity.com/2026/07/09/reddit-false-report-scam-direct-message/>

05. Product showcase: Protect your iPhone with McAfee Mobile Security

McAfee Mobile Security for iOS combines scam protection, web protection, VPN, Wi-Fi security, and device security checks in a single app. It is also available for Android. After downloading the app from the App Store, I created an account and completed a short onboarding process. The app asks whether you want to receive notifications before offering to run...

Why it matters: Breaches and cybercrime activity signal where attackers are focusing and what data types are actively monetized.

Recommendation: Validate incident-response readiness, monitor for exposed credentials, and reinforce MFA, phishing resistance, and data-loss controls.

Sources: <https://www.helpnetsecurity.com/2026/07/09/product-showcase-mcafee-mobile-security-ios/>

06. Messaging fraud trends point to smarter attacks, stronger blocking

Fraudsters spent 2025 investing in scale. New routes, new tools, and higher message volumes moved through the SMS, voice, and chat channels that businesses rely on to reach customers. Money follows that activity. The Communications Fraud Control Association puts global telecom fraud losses at around 42 billion dollars for the year, several billion higher than...

Why it matters: Breaches and cybercrime activity signal where attackers are focusing and what data types are actively monetized.

Recommendation: Validate incident-response readiness, monitor for exposed credentials, and reinforce MFA, phishing resistance, and data-loss controls.

Sources: <https://www.helpnetsecurity.com/2026/07/09/infobip-messaging-fraud-trends/>

07. Mount Royal University confirms breach as hackers claim attack

Mount Royal University in Calgary says hackers stole and then deleted data from its file storage systems after breaching the university's network. [...]

Why it matters: Breaches and cybercrime activity signal where attackers are focusing and what data types are actively monetized.

Recommendation: Validate incident-response readiness, monitor for exposed credentials, and reinforce MFA, phishing resistance, and data-loss controls.

Sources: <https://www.bleepingcomputer.com/news/security/mount-royal-university-confirms-breach-as-hackers-claim-attack/>

08. Lone Attacker Uses AI to Breach AWS Cloud Environment in 72 Hours

The attacker exploited AI workflows, chained cloud weaknesses, and stolen credentials to extort a large Amazon customer.

Why it matters: Breaches and cybercrime activity signal where attackers are focusing and what data types are actively monetized.

Recommendation: Validate incident-response readiness, monitor for exposed credentials, and reinforce MFA, phishing resistance, and data-loss controls.

Sources: <https://www.darkreading.com/cloud-security/lone-attacker-ai-breach-aws-cloud-environment>

09. Designing for the inevitable: System prompt leakage and mitigations in generative AI applications

System prompts form the foundation of generative AI applications. A system prompt is a collection of instructions and operational context provided to a large language model (LLM) that shapes how the model behaves and interacts with users and tools. System prompts often contain proprietary information, including role definitions, behavioral guidelines, tool...

Why it matters: Breaches and cybercrime activity signal where attackers are focusing and what data types are actively monetized.

Recommendation: Validate incident-response readiness, monitor for exposed credentials, and reinforce MFA, phishing resistance, and data-loss controls.

Sources: <https://aws.amazon.com/blogs/security/designing-for-the-inevitable-system-prompt-leakage-and-mitigations-in-generative-ai-applications/>

10. Felons, Fraudsters Flog Offensive Cybersecurity Startup

A cybersecurity startup dangling millions of dollars to acquire zero-day security vulnerabilities in popular software is run by a pair of far-right conspiracy theorists and convicted felons whose most recent ventures included fake intelligence companies and a now-defunct AI-based lobbying platform they operated under assumed names.

Why it matters: Breaches and cybercrime activity signal where attackers are focusing and what data types are actively monetized.

Recommendation: Validate incident-response readiness, monitor for exposed credentials, and reinforce MFA, phishing resistance, and data-loss controls.

Sources: <https://krebsonsecurity.com/2026/07/felons-fraudsters-flog-offensive-cybersecurity-startup/>